

Q1 Where did the inauguration ceremony take place? Why was it a historic occasion?

Ans The inauguration ceremony took place in the sandstone amphitheatre formed by the Union Buildings in Pretoria. It was a historic occasion because it marked the birth of a new, free, and democratic South Africa, with Nelson Mandela becoming the country's first black President after the end of the long period of apartheid.

Q2 What twin obligations does Mandela mention?

Ans Mandela mentions that every man has twin obligations in life. The first is his obligation to his family - to his parents, wife, and children. The second is his obligation to his people, his community, and his country.

Q3 What does courage mean to Mandela?

Ans To Mandela, courage does not mean the absence of fear, but the triumph over it.

A brave man is not one who does not feel afraid, but one who conquers that fear and continues to fight despite it.

Q4 What did Freedom mean to Mandela when he was a boy and when he was a student?

Ans As a boy, Mandela thought he was born free, and Freedom meant simple things - being free to run in the fields, to swim in the streams, and to roam whenever he wished, as long as he obeyed his father and the customs of his tribe. As a student, Freedom meant transient, personal things - the Freedom to stay out at night, to read what he pleased, and to go wherever he choose. At that stage, he only wanted Freedom for himself, and had not yet realised that the Freedom of his people was being taken away.

Q5 What does Mandela mean by "an extraordinary human disaster"?

Ans Mandela uses this phrase to describe the brutal system of apartheid in South Africa. It refers to the decades of racial discrimination and oppression inflicted upon the Black population by the white rulers causing immense suffering and robbing people of their basic freedom.